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PUNCTUATION

COMMA – ,

1. X, Y, and Z

I like **studying**, **reading** books, *and* **watching** movies.

When we have 3+ elements in the list, we write a comma before *and*.

I enjoy eating potatoes, tomatoes, cucumbers, *and* aubergine.

2. Between two clauses (S+V) before **FANBOYS** (Coordinating Conjunctions).

F – FOR = BECAUSE

A – AND = TO ADD INFORMATION

N – NOR = NEGATIVE

B – BUT = CONTRAST

O – OR = GIVING A CHOICE, ALTERNATIVE

Y – YET = BUT

S – SO = RESULT

I like reading books, *BUT* **my brother prefers** watching TV. – Compound Sentence

The SAT preparation is quite challenging, *YET* it is worth it. – Compound Sentence (two parts are independent from each other)

3. In Complex Sentences, when the dependent clause comes first.

When I come home, *I will call you.*

When I come home – dependent,

I will call you – independent

I will call you when I come home.

4. For additional information or explanation.

Additional information – the type of information that can be removed.

John Green, *a famous American author*, **has published** his new book.

Maria Smith, *a new student in our class*, **has completed** her homework successfully.

5. that

,which

Farid's cars **that** are never kept clean should never be driven.

Farid's cars, **which** are never kept clean, should never be driven.

I have completed the task, **which** I considered to be difficult.

6. Between two adjectives when **a comma** can be paraphrased with **“and”**

The tall, **(AND)** graceful giraffes.

SEMI-COLON – ;

1. Between two clauses (S+V) when there is no conjunction between them.

I prefer drinking tea; **my brother enjoys** drinking coffee.

2. Between two independent clauses linked by a **transitional expression** (**however, furthermore, nevertheless, moreover, in addition, etc.**).

I was exhausted; **however**, I managed to complete myhomework.

HOWEVER = BUT

Everyone was happy because of her. I was,**however**, dissatisfied.

3. In lists with internal commas.

The new store will have groceries *on the lower level*; luggage, housewares, and electronics (X, Y, and Z) *on the ground floor*; men's and women's clothing *on the second floor*; and books, music, and stationery (X, Y, and Z) *on the third floor*.

COLON – :

1. Introducing a list of items.

The bookstore specializes in three *subjects*: art, architecture, and graphic design.

2. Between two clauses, when the second one explains the first (or it can be paraphrased with “because”)

I did not go to school: I was feeling sick.

3. Emphasis.

After three weeks of deliberation, the jury finally reached a verdict: *guilty*.

DASH – =

1. Emphasis.

After three weeks of deliberation, the jury finally reached a verdict – *guilty*.

2. In additional information or explanation.

John Green – *a famous American author* – **has published** his new book.

John Green (*a famous American author*) **has published** his new book.

His spelling mistakes (**all 143 of them**) have finally been corrected.

His spelling mistakes – **all 143 of them** – have finally been corrected.

His spelling mistakes, **all 143 of them**, have finally been corrected.